

Question Paper

Course: Knowing India Through Data

Time: 45 minutes

Full Marks: 25 Marks

Answer all questions

1. What is the key difference between census, survey, and administrative data? Explain with one example of each from India. **(3 marks)**
2. Based on Census projections, is India expected to become older or younger (in terms of median age) between 2011 and 2036? Will there be any variation across states? **(2 marks)**
3. Consider the following statement:

"PLFS data shows that unemployment rate in India in January 2026 is about 5%. The rate is low, so the Indian labour market is doing well."

Critically evaluate whether the conclusion follows from the evidence presented. In your answer, explain the limitations of using the unemployment rate as a sole indicator of labour market performance, and identify additional indicators you would use to arrive at a more comprehensive assessment. **(10 marks, approx. 400-500 words)**

4. Estimates of consumption expenditure in India derived from the Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES) often diverge substantially from those reported in the National Accounts Statistics (NAS), with NAS typically indicating higher levels of consumption. Critically examine the sources of this divergence and evaluate the implication of relying on one source over the other. **(10 marks, approx. 400-500 words)**